

Diagnostics waiting over six weeks

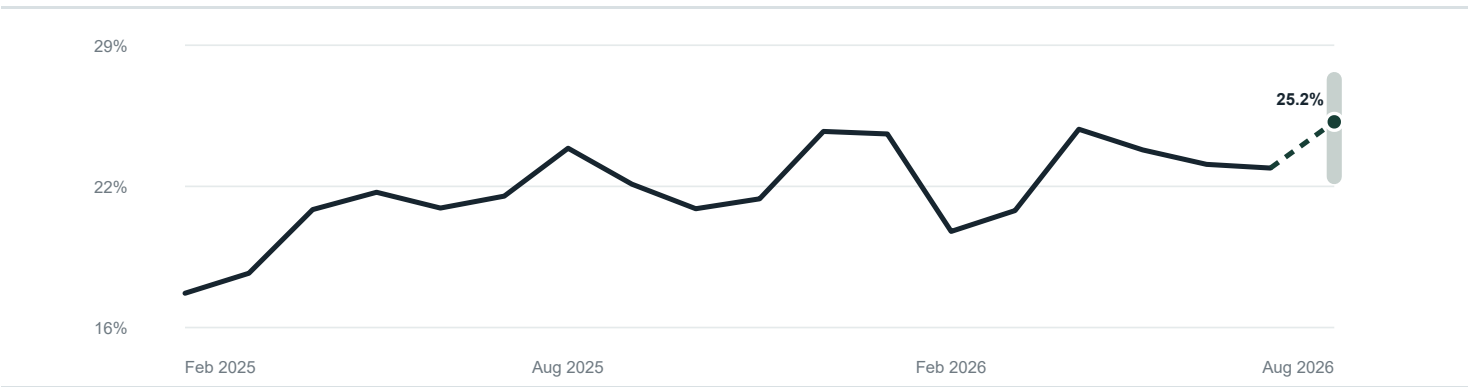
Forecast for August 2026 · data through July 2026

Diagnostics waiting over six weeks is forecast to deteriorate at the next release, from 23.1% to 25.2%. The model's expected deterioration is mainly due to the usual month-to-month seasonal movement; the underlying trend is broadly flat. The current projection is off course for 14% or less by March 2027. Sustained favourable/adverse provider signals: 42/40.

LATEST · JULY 2026	OUTLOOK · AUGUST 2026	ACTUAL
23.1%	25.2%	
No archived pre-release forecast	80% range 22.7%–27.2%	Not yet released
		Off course · 14% or less by March 2027

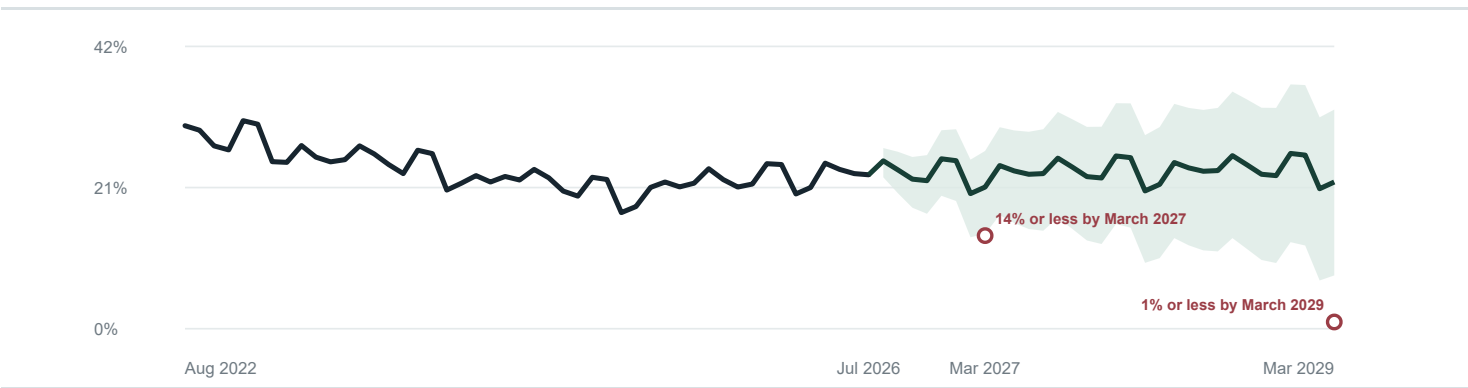
Recent performance and next release

The vertical band is the 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



Benchmark: 1% operational standard. 7.3pp above milestone

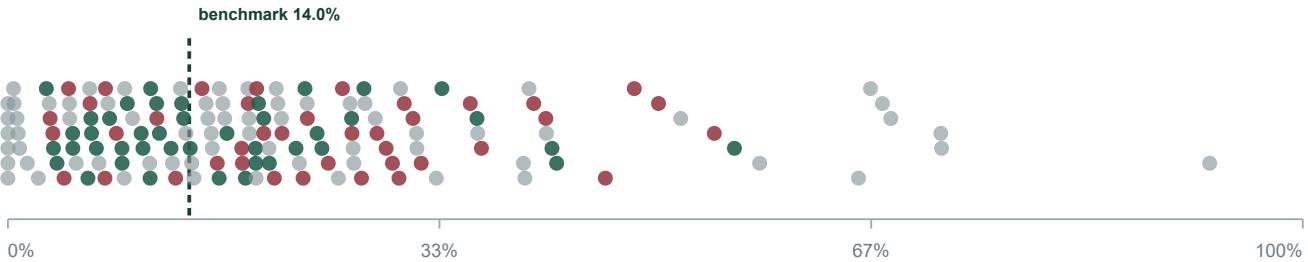
Data: NHS England diagnostic waiting times and activity. Targets: Medium Term Planning Framework national

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Distribution and trajectory watch · July 2026

Provider distribution

Latest reported performance across providers. This is a comparison of current levels, not a measure of whether each provider is improving or deteriorating.



Trajectory watch

Signals show sustained departures from each provider's own archived outlook. A low performer can be improving, and a high performer can be deteriorating. Status: Actual performance is compared with the monthly path forecast six months earlier. The displayed figure is the average gap across those six months.

142

providers assessed

42

sustained favourable

40

sustained adverse

60

without an active signal

Largest sustained favourable moves

Kent Community Health NHS Foundation Trust Latest 27.5% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest	43.9pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH
King's College Hospital NHS Foundation Trust Latest 19.1% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest	29.6pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH
Royal Surrey NHS Foundation Trust Latest 8.8% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest	28.2pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH

Largest sustained adverse moves

East Kent Hospitals University NHS Foundation Trust Latest 48.4% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest	20.3pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH
Dorset Healthcare University NHS Foundation Trust Latest 31.9% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest	20.1pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH
Cambridge University Hospitals NHS Foundation Trust Latest 26.6% · 6 months compared with a path fixed six months earlier fixed six month path backtest	18.6pp AVERAGE GAP FROM FIXED PATH

Trajectory-watch rule. Six consecutive release surprises are compared with forecasts made before each release. A signal requires a material average gap, at least five of six months in the same direction, and the latest month confirming that direction. These are screening prompts—not league tables, causal estimates or judgements of provider quality.